

The easiest thing you can do if you want to hack college is to forget everything you've heard about the importance of going to a prestigious (i.e., expensive) school. Robert Farrington, who writes *The College Investor* blog, shared his experience of working his way up the chain from part-time clerk to store manager at a Target retail store. Climbing the corporate ladder enabled him to earn \$180,000 per year, which he described as average for someone in his position.

Farrington observed that having a degree is important in getting jobs and promotions in big companies, but often not for the reasons people think. When asked if he felt having a degree was a big piece of his career success, he replied, "Yes and no. It's one of those things that it's the paper that shows you care. Did it actually give me any skills to be successful? I don't think so."

While some companies have started to recognize that a degree is less of a necessity, others continue to use it as a screening tool. There is value in having a degree to check that box on the application, but it is wise to get the degree as quickly and as inexpensively as possible.

Farrington believes people are being oversold on the value of college based on what he hears from readers of *The College Investor*. People reach out to him after they've taken on too much